Starter's Hut

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BDT 2004 · Lagos · Featuring Knoxy

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



Penina

For Round I of BDT 2004 we visited legendary Portuguese course, Penina. A Henry Cotton course built in 1966 it is considered the most historic course in the south of Portugal and paved the way for numerous other courses in The Algarve, so the Dogs had assembled on the first tee looking forward to doing it justice!

Knoxy was in the first group out and what followed next is one of the most fondly remembered moments of tour history. Over to Knoxy to talk you through his experience!



Knoxy with his Doggles



KNOXY

"As some of you may know my Big Dog is rather lazy and generally only gets out of his kennel once a year (ie on the first hole of the third round of BDT). So you can appreciate the Big Dog is a little excited when he does get out and is surrounded by 15 other shiny big dogs all straining at the leash for yet another round of golf.

Stepping up to the tee on BDT should be something to savour. The course is beautiful, the weather is beautiful and the round is about to start. Unfortunately I would be lying if I told you what the first hole looked like on any of the 1st holes I have had the privilege of playing during my BDT career to date! As I can usually focus no further than the end of my Big Dog at this point on tour.

Stepping up to the tee on this occasion was no different. However, with a new Big Dog in hand sold to me on the premise of "you can't miss the sweet spot on this baby"....I had a little Barry Chuckle to myself at the point of sale...I had cause for HOPE Johanna!

Backswing went as usual, as smooth as an Afghan motorway. At the top of the swing, contrary to what I learned from the advice on the BDT website, of all the things I should have been thinking about, I was thinking "please go straight and at least 100 yards". Unfortunately neither of these happy thoughts came off!

> At point of contact I heard 3 noises, one of which I would like to say was me hitting the ball, but to this day I can't be certain. My ball toed from the dog head (don't think the sweet spot reached round that far) shot off at a 50 degree angle to me on the tee, hit the tee box marker reversing its trajectory back past me, clipped the small wall on the right of the tee box and bounced up over the official starter, hitting the starter's hut on its way down; some 30 yards behind me.
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> Thankfully the starter was eyes down looking at his tee times, so just heard a noise and saw a ball resting next to his hut. I can only imagine he gave the fourball coming into the 18th a right b*llocking when they walked by.
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> With many to choose from, this one still stands out as a true one hit blunder!"

Superb stuff from Knoxy and when we revisited Penina on BDT 2022 he was delighted to revisit the scene of the crime!



The legendary starter's hut at Penina!